

Phase 7: The Golden Shadow – Reclaiming Power

*“Our deepest fear is not that we are inadequate. Our deepest fear is
that we are powerful beyond measure.”*

— Marianne Williamson

You may feel an uncomfortable stirring in your chest as you read these words—a strange mixture of longing and resistance. Perhaps your breath catches, or a quiet voice whispers, “This isn’t about me.” Notice this. **The contraction against your own greatness is the golden shadow, asking to be reclaimed.**

Not all of the shadow is dark. Jung recognized that we exile not only our “negative” qualities but also our **positive** ones—our brilliance, our power, our most luminous gifts. This is the **Golden Shadow**: the parts of yourself that were too bright, too talented, too magnificent. So you hid them away to fit in. To belong. To survive.

Perhaps you were told not to be too smart, lest you make others feel inferior. Perhaps you learned that your beauty attracted jealousy, your ambition invited criticism, your sensitivity was “too much.” Perhaps your family system required you to stay small so others could feel okay. And so you collapsed your chest, lowered your gaze, dimmed your light—and called this modesty, humility, or simply “being realistic.”

The body holds the suppression of brightness just as it holds the suppression of darkness. A collapsed posture guards against visibility. A quiet voice protects against being heard. Chronic fatigue may be the exhaustion of constantly holding back your true energy. Reclaiming the Golden Shadow is not about becoming arrogant—it is about **permission**. Permission to shine. Permission to succeed. Permission to occupy your full size in the world. This is not vanity; it is the completion of individuation.

In this phase, you will:

- Identify the hidden gifts and talents you have buried
- Understand the family and cultural systems that required your dimming
- Map where you hold back your brilliance in your body

- Practice the embodied experience of wearing your power without apology